

technologies we use include Apache Web servers and JQuery. Our core platform, the development of which is done by our team, is based on Java. There are some open source libraries that we use frequently, like JQuery." So, do open source developers fit the bill better? Well, apparently not! Here's what Ali has to say, "We essentially look for good developers, who have good coding knowledge. Frankly, the discussion has gone way beyond open source or non-open source. If developers are skilled, they can be trained to work on any platform. So, it is the coding skills that make a good developer. Of course, if they have knowledge about the technologies that we use, it is an advantage."

Finding the right talent is a challenge

India is rich in talent, which is why Ali chose to expand the development wing in the country. He takes pride in saying, "India has got the best software talent out there. I am based in Silicon Valley. There are many companies I work with personally and I find that Indian talent has an upper edge. Our new facility is based on the confidence that we will be able to find the required talent. I can proudly say that we, as a company, have grown on the basis of software that was made by people in India."

Though India has no dearth of software talent, surely there is a dearth of developers with exceptional coding skills? Ali agrees, saying, "It's hard to find developers with

superb coding skills. We are always looking out for good programmers, developers and engineers. Good coding skills is definitely not a common thing. It really doesn't matter where the developers come from and what kind of technological background they have had in the past; what really matters is the way they write code and their programming skills."

Skava believes that the present availability of good talent is courtesy the education provided in our engineering colleges, but there are changes that are required to make things better. Ali explains, "People are good with their theory, but they are not strong in executing the theory. So, to improve the scenario, we plan to interact with a lot of colleges and let the HoDs know what kind of skills are really in demand in the market, in order to make the engineers employable. We keep on communicating with the colleges and we are planning a formal outreach plan with institutions. This includes holding coding contests, going to the campuses and telling them about the latest technologies. We want to make sure that the students also realise what coding skills they require if they want to continue working in the software industry for a longer period of time. For instance, if they are learning programming in COBOL, it may not be very useful for them, but learning iOS and Android programming will be of great help in the future as well, because these platforms are here to stay." 

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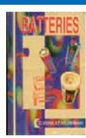
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